

I Tell the Moon My Secret and the Moon Tells Me Yours

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1 DESCRIPTION OF ARTWORK

I Tell the Moon My Secret and the Moon Tells Me Yours (ITMMSMTMY) is an interactive piece that pairs a robotic arm with the Moon to create light painting photographs to visualize the gathered secrets. The audience can share their secrets on a portal that generates the waveform. The waveform data, once generated, are computed into coordinates and dispatched to the robotic system. The robot arm continues to depict the waveform, but the movement can only be successfully captured by the long-exposure camera when the Moon appears within a certain field of view, since the Moon is the exclusive light source during the long-exposure process.

Light painting photographs are images created by 'drawing' or 'painting' with a moving light source, captured by a camera in a fixed location using a long exposure. In this project, the Moon serves as a relatively static light source, while the camera, mounted on the robot arm's flange, moves with the arm, capturing the Moon's trace with a slow shutter speed, akin to the robotic arm using the Moon as a paintbrush. The creative process highlights the expression of digital signals in an uncontrollable physical world. No matter how precisely the robot arm can depict the waveform, the final result remains subject to the Moon's presence and visibility. The role of the Moon undergoes a transformation from a traditionally literary object to an active participant. The project establishes a space for nature as a subject, positioning it as a dynamic and uncontrollable performer rather than merely a literary object of study or appreciation.

The act of sharing secrets with the moon serves as a poetic portrayal. In this process, akin to entrusting a silent confidant, humans delegate the robot arm as an agent to "whisper" these secrets to the Moon. Each secret is encoded into precise data for the robotic system to render, becoming inaudible to humans. Yet, whether the language will manifest visually hinges on environmental conditions—namely, air quality, cloud density, and the Moon's phase, all of which affect the Moon's visibility. When the Moon is visible, the secrets are visualized in a cryptic way by the Moon; when the Moon is hidden, the secrets dissolve into the dark expanse of the



night sky. Either way, secrets remain secrets, merely in another form of language.

2 PROJECT URL

<https://zoelismwork.persona.co/itmmsmtmy>

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